

# Problem 9

## Problem 9

**Problem 1** (a) Given function  $f$  on an interval  $[a, b]$ :

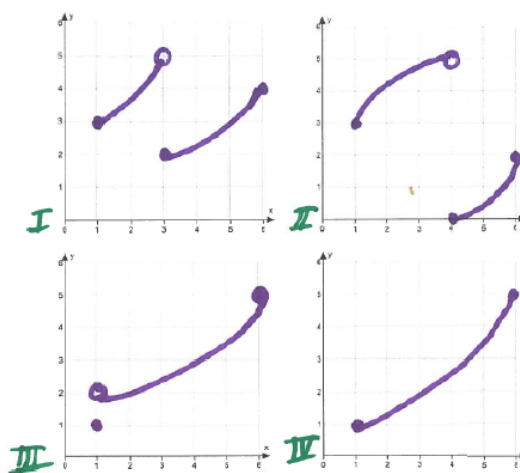
- (i) What are the conditions of the Intermediate Value Theorem?

**Explanation.**  $f$  is continuous on the interval  $[a, b]$

- (ii) What is the conclusion of the Intermediate Value Theorem?

**Explanation.** For any number  $L$  strictly between  $f(a)$  and  $f(b)$ , there is at least one number  $c$  in  $(a, b)$  satisfying  $f(c) = L$ . This means that for any  $L$  strictly between  $f(a)$  and  $f(b)$ , the horizontal line  $y = L$  intersects the graph of  $f$ .

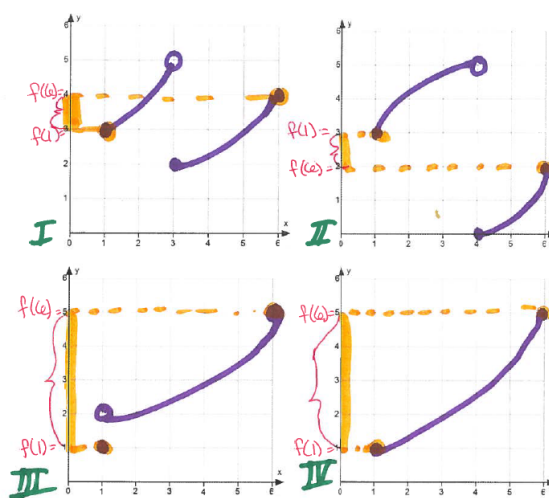
- (b) Given the four functions on the interval  $[1, 6]$ , answer the questions below.



- (i) For each of the functions I through IV, indicate  $f(1)$  and  $f(6)$ . Then mark the interval of all numbers strictly between  $f(1)$  and  $f(6)$ , on the y-axis.

**Explanation.**

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- (ii) For each of the functions I through IV, write an interval of all numbers strictly between  $f(1)$  and  $f(6)$

**Explanation.**  $f = I$ :  $(3, 4)$

$f = II$ :  $(2, 3)$

$f = III$ :  $(1, 5)$

$f = IV$ :  $(1, 5)$

- (iii) List the functions that satisfy the conditions of the Intermediate Value Theorem on  $[1, 6]$

**Explanation.** Only function IV is continuous on  $[1, 6]$

- (iv) For which of the functions is the following statement true: For any number  $L$  strictly between  $f(1)$  and  $f(6)$ , there exists a number  $c$  in  $(1, 6)$  satisfying  $f(c) = L$ .

**Explanation.** The statement is true for functions I and IV

- (v) Does the function III satisfy the conclusion of the Intermediate Value Theorem? Why or why not?

**Explanation.** No, function III does not satisfy the conclusion of the IVT. For example, take  $L = 1.5$ .  $f(c) = 1.5$  has no solution in  $(1, 6)$ . Draw the horizontal line  $y = 1.5$ . What do you notice? This line does not intersect the graph of function III. What does this mean? The function does not attain that value, 1.5. So there is no  $c$  in  $(1, 6)$  such that  $f(c) = 1.5$ .